9.2 When to use non-UI acceptance tests

The business logic or business rules of an application describe how the application is expected to deliver business value, as well as the constraints under which it will operate. Business logic looks beyond how a user interacts with the application and focuses on what the user expects to achieve. The UI and user experience play an essential role in helping users get the most out of an application, but if you aren't clear on the underlying business rules and constraints, even the best-designed UIs will be wasted on features that are of limited practical value to your end users.

Business logic includes things like these:

- What are the expected outcomes, in business terms, of a particular user action?
- How does your application or business differentiate itself from its competitors? What makes it better than the legacy application you're replacing?
- What business rules need to be applied?
- What business-related constraints apply to user actions?

For example, suppose you're promoting a special Flying High–endorsed credit card that members can use to earn Frequent Flyer points when they make purchases. Because this is a web-based application with a rich user experience, web tests will play a critical role in your testing strategy. You'll need to verify the user's journey through the screens to apply for a new credit card, check on how successful and failing applications are displayed, ensure appropriate legal texts are agreed to, and so forth.

For example, an automated web test might be a good way to verify how the Frequent Flyer home page encourages members to apply for the new credit card:

```
Scenario: The Frequent Flyers site encourages members to apply for the new
     credit card
Given Joe is a Flying High Frequent Flyer
When Joe views his account home page
Then he should be able to apply for a Flying High Credit Card
```

CUCUMBER EXAMPLES The approaches discussed here are relatively implementation-neutral and tool-agnostic, but I did need to choose a format for the sample code. In the previous chapter we discussed examples built using JBehave and Thucydides, so in this chapter you'll use Cucumber.

Other examples of useful web-based scenarios might describe the user's journey through the application process:

```
Scenario: Joe is eligible for a Flying High Credit Card
Given Joe is a Flying High Frequent Flyer eligible for automatic Credit Card
     approval
When Joe applies for a Flying High Credit Card
Then Joe should be informed that his application was successful
And Joe should receive a confirmation email
And Joe's application should be queued for approval

Scenario: Joe is not eligible for a Flying High Credit Card
Given Joe is a Flying High Frequent Flyer who is not eligible for automatic
     Credit Card approval
```